flowers in acropetal succession. Example: *Crotalaria retusa,* Mustard.

b. Spike: Spike is an unbranched indeterminate inflorescence with **sessile flowers**. Example: *Achyranthes* (chaff flower).

c. Spikelet: Literally it is a small spike. The Inflorescence is with branched central axis. Each branch is a **spikelet**. Sessile flowers are formed in acropetal succession on the axis. A pair of inflorescence bracts called **glumes** is present at the base. Each sessile flower has a **lemma** (bract) and a **palea** (bracteole). Tepals reduced to colourless scaly leaves (lodicule). Each flower has stamen and pistil only. Example: Paddy, Wheat.

d. Catkin: **Pendulous spikes** with a long and drooping axis bearing small unisexual or bisexual flowers. It is also called **ament**. Example: *Acalypha hispida*, *Prosopis juliflora.*

e. Spadix: An inflorescence with a fleshy or thickened central axis that possesses many unisexual sessile flowers in acropetal succession. Usually female flowers are found towards the base and male flowers are found at the apex. Entire inflorescence is covered by a brightly coloured or hard bract called a **spathe**. Example: *Amorphophallus*, *Colocasia.*

f. Panicle*:* A branched raceme is called **panicle**. Example: *Mangifera,* neem. It is also called **Compound raceme** or **Raceme of Racemes**.

2. Main axis shortened:

Inflorescence with reduced growth of central axis. There are two types, namely corymb and umbel.

a. Corymb: An inflorescence with shorter pedicellate flowers at the top and longer

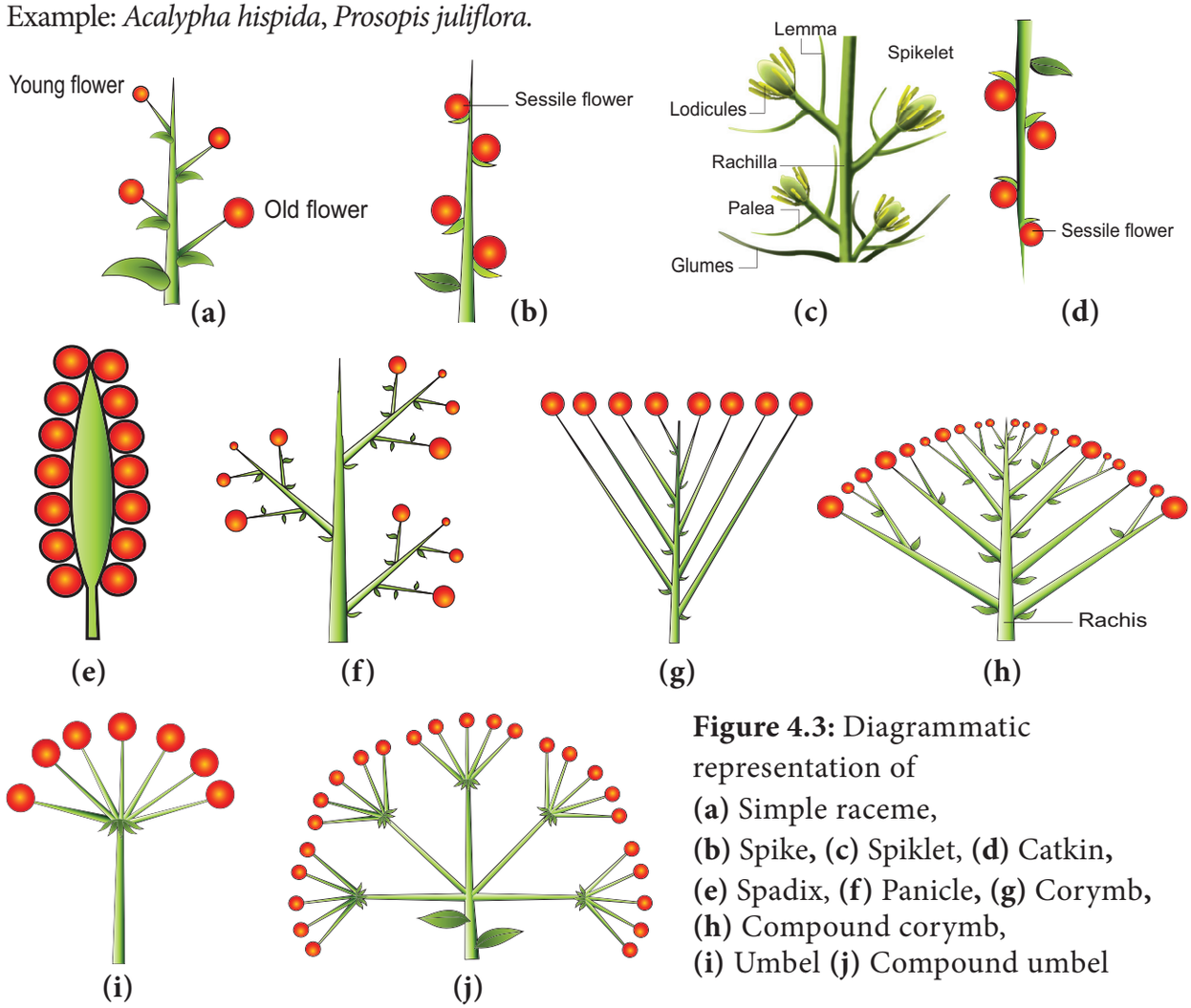


Figure 4.3: Diagrammatic representation of
(a) Simple raceme,
(b) Spike, **(c)** Spiklet, **(d)** Catkin,
(e) Spadix, **(f)** Panicle, **(g)** Corymb,
(h) Compound corymb,
(i) Umbel **(j)** Compound umbel

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